

Rep Cadou Jr. Sports Editor
CALLS 'EM

"MAN, THIS IS really a tough job," said new manager Johnny Hutchings yesterday as we labored at the task of selecting the winner of The Indianapolis Star's ninth annual Bat Boy contest.

Compared to the assignment of picking a winning bat boy out of a field of 10 top contenders, Hutchings' job of selecting a starting pitcher for today's season's opener with the Minneapolis Millers was duck soup. *

Cloyd Boyer earned the starting mound job for the Indianapolis Indians with little doubt. But, Clark LeRoy Dickerson had a whale of a battle on his hands to win the bat boy job.

Dickerson, a 15-year-old George Washington High School sophomore who has a 94 per cent grade average, was adjudged the winner only after close interrogation and extensive discussion by Hutchings, Indians general manager Ray Johnston and this writer.

It was the fourth time that Dickerson had entered the contest, which should provide some kind of lesson in persistence for future contenders.

Clark was a finalist the last three years but never quite made the grade. An all-around athlete, he played on the Washington freshman football and basketball teams as well as playing first base on the reserve baseball team this semester.

In addition to his high scholastic standing, Clark scored heavily in the bat boy competition because of his size. He is 6-2 and weighs 155 pounds.

"A big, rugged boy is just what we need for this job," said Hutchings.

"THIS IS one of the biggest thrills of my life and I want to thank everybody," young Dickerson said.

The son of Mr. and Mrs. Earl L. Dickerson of 510 South Addison Street, Clark has been playing baseball for five years and has played every position but pitcher, shortstop and third base.

His favorite Indian during 1959 was J. C. Martin, who had a fling with the White Sox this Spring but now is playing at San Diego.

Clark has averaged seeing more than 35 games a season during the last few years. He was on the high honor roll at Washington. He is saving money to go to college but hasn't picked his school as yet.

"I would like to be bat boy for the Indianapolis Indians," Dickerson wrote, "because it would be a perfect ending to my childhood dreams."

"I have wanted to be the bat boy ever since I have been able to understand baseball. I would consider it a great privilege to aid and assist the players I have watched and admired from the stands."

Runnerup for the bat boy honors was 14-year-old Joseph Romer of 5809 Beechwood Avenue, a Cathedral High School freshman with a 90 per cent grade average. Young Romer plays shortstop and the outfield and is captain of his team.

ANDY COHEN, the former Indians' manager, has a big-league managerial record that will be hard to eclipse—or even tie.

Managing the Phillies in his one-game interim stint before Gene Mauch showed up, Cohen beat Milwaukee, 5-4, in 10 innings. That probably will be one of the few victories the Phils score over the Braves this season.

Maybe our Indians will profit during the series which opens this afternoon in the change of Miller direction which will put Ed Papowsk

in charge of the club in place of Mauch.

HEY, DAD, open up your wallet.

The average American family will spend \$215 on sporting goods this year, according to Hardward Age. Biggest expenditure will be on boating, with fishing, bowling, hunting and basketball next in order.

And, you know who will pay the bills.

JIMMY BRYAN'S new Metal-Cal Special for the 1960 500-mile race will be a "real dirt-track roadster," according to builder and chief mechanic George Salih.

Salih, who designed the car which won for Bryan in 1958 and Sam Hanks in 1957, has a new creation which weighs only 1,600 pounds.

"I'm not taking anything away from the old car," said Salih, "but it was designed for Indianapolis only and could not compete on dirt and other tracks.

"My new car actually is built around Bryan."

Driveshaft of the car is on the right of Bryan and Salih believes the fact the driver will sit on the left will result in "eliminating wind buffeting which has plagued past Indianapolis competitors."

The engine is flat, laying 15 degrees from horizontal to the left and mounted eight inches to the right of the center of the chassis.

RODGER WARD, winner of the 1959 500-mile race, was surrounded by fans and signing autographs after a recent midget race at Los Angeles where Ward dropped out because of engine trouble.

"And what can I do for you?" said Ward patting one youngster of about 8 on the head.

"Tell me, what's your excuse this time?" said the youngster to the flabbergasted driver.

It was a put-up job. The lad was the son of the mechanic who works on Ward's stock car.

BOB COLLINS of The Star says it will be one of the ranking construction wonders of the world if they finish that new speedway being built down at Charlotte, N.C., in time for the 600-mile stock-car race scheduled for May 29.

Down there to receive a sportswriting award, Collins visited the track site. Just the shell of the track and no stands are up, Collins reports. Crews are working 24 hours a day to try to get it done in time.

Late Thursday Box Scores

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